

Buyer Beware!

A look at how by buying online you may be putting your warranty eligibility at risk. So say the manufacturers...

Security watch

With newer threats emerging every day it pays to keep an eye on the security landscape. That's what we're here for.

Behind the mask of efficacy

Not all is what it seems in the tech world. This month we take a look at major companies who seem to be concurrently winning and struggling with their offerings

Transparent sensors in Gorilla Glass panel

Researchers at a Canadian university have successfully implanted transparent sensors into Corning's Gorilla Glass. This development could help in the manufacture of touchscreens with sensory devices. Soon we could have smart-



Sensors have been successfully embedded into a Gorilla Glass panel

phones with sensors embedded into their screen!

This is the first time sensors have been successfully embedded into a Gorilla Glass panel. The researchers say that Corning's product was the best option for such an experiment as they were able to achieve the lowest-measured loss value, fastest fabrication times and the longest high-quality waveguides of any glass ever.

The researchers used optical waveguides to throw photos directly through the glass panel itself instead of running electricity through wires.

Raman Kashyap, a professor of electrical engineering at the Polytechnique Montreal in Canada, says, "It should be

possible for manufacturers to begin building this technology into smartphones within a year with 'focused development'. We're actively looking to partner with industry to exploit this technology."

According to a paper published by the researchers at Optics InfoBase, a sensor was passed into the scratch-resistant glass for the first time. The researchers reportedly took 10 seconds to write sensors into the glass using waveguides.

They also found a way by which to ensure that a phone couldn't be cloned. This was made possible by successfully passing a unique waveform into the panel, which glows uniquely when an infrared light is passed through it.

According to PC World, Corning hasn't yet given out any statements officially affiliating itself with the experiment, despite having its own researcher Ming-Jun Li as part of the team that carried out the experiment.

Motorola admits Moto G issues

In June, Motorola India resolved the problem of Moto G smartphones with unregistered IMEI numbers – a problem that may

have caused some units of the popular Android smartphone sold in India to not work on domestic networks. Motorola apologised for the issue and said that it had offered affected customers both, a full refund and the choice to replace the faulty handset, apart from a ₹1,200 credit to their Flipkart accounts. We don't know how many users were affected by the IMEI problem or how many chose to return their handsets for a refund, and both, Motorola and Flipkart haven't released any figures.

Motorola stated that it has reached out to the customers who bought 16GB Moto G units with IMEI numbers that began with 3533, as these were



Motorola said that the problem was one-off

the units that were most likely facing issues. Motorola also disclosed that the problem was "one-off" and that it had taken measures to ensure that the error didn't recur.

HTC sells 50k One (E8) units within 15 mins of launch

HTC One (E8) sold over 50,000 units within just 15 minutes of its launch in China. The mid-range smartphone has generated a huge interest in the public with over two million people "reserving" the device at a large online retailer.

The HTC One E8 has the same specs as the HTC One M8, including the Snapdragon quad-core 2.5GHz processor and Android v4.4 Kitkat out of the box. It has a 5-inch LCD display and comes with a plastic body. HTC has eliminated the duo cam and aluminum body of the M8 to make the device cheaper.

It has a 13MP rear camera with autofocus and LED flash as well as a 5MP front camera for video calling. The smartphone has 16GB/32GB on-board storage expandable up to 32GB via microSD card. Connectivity options included are 4G LTE connectivity, Wi-Fi and GPS/GLO-NASS. The smartphone packs a 2600mAh battery and is available in

Polar White, Maldives Blue, Electric Crimson and Misty Grey colors.

The One E8 doesn't have the metal construction and the Ultra-Pixel duo camera of